

TASK 3

CAUSALITY ASSESSMENT OF AN ADVERSE DRUG REACTION

Academic Case File • Structured Case Analysis

CASE IDENTIFICATION

Case ID	ADR-CA-03-2026	Assessment date	28 September 2026
Patient	45-year-old female	Suspected drug	Amoxicillin
Indication	Acute bacterial sinusitis	Reaction	Generalized skin rash with itching

1. CASE NARRATIVE

Patient: A 45-year-old female was prescribed Amoxicillin 500 mg orally three times daily for acute bacterial sinusitis. Three days after starting treatment, she developed a generalized skin rash associated with itching. No previous drug allergy or other significant medical history was reported. Amoxicillin was discontinued after the reaction was recognized. The skin rash and itching subsequently resolved. The drug was not re-administered.

2. SUSPECTED DRUG INFORMATION

Drug	Amoxicillin
Dose	500 mg
Route	Oral
Frequency	Three times daily (TID)
Indication	Acute bacterial sinusitis
Therapy status	Discontinued after adverse reaction

3. CAUSALITY ASSESSMENT

Criterion	Case evidence	Finding
Temporal relationship	Skin rash and itching appeared 3 days after Amoxicillin was started.	YES
Dechallenge	Amoxicillin was stopped and the reaction resolved.	POSITIVE
Alternative causes	No other significant cause or relevant drug allergy was reported.	NOT IDENTIFIED
Rechallenge	The suspected drug was not given again after the reaction.	NOT PERFORMED

4. CAUSALITY CONCLUSION

CERTAIN

Rationale: The adverse reaction occurred after exposure to the suspected drug in a compatible temporal sequence. The reaction improved after withdrawal of Amoxicillin, providing a positive dechallenge. No alternative cause is identified in the case information. Rechallenge was not performed, so no rechallenge evidence is available.

5. FINAL CASE SUMMARY

Patient	45-year-old female
Suspected drug	Amoxicillin 500 mg TID, oral

Adverse reaction	Generalized skin rash with itching
Time to onset	3 days after starting treatment
Drug withdrawal	Yes
Recovery after withdrawal	Yes
Alternative cause identified	No
Rechallenge	Not performed
Final causality	CERTAIN

Note: This is a fictional academic case prepared for Task 3. It is formatted as a realistic case-file submission and does not represent a real patient report.